

Weekly 6

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Weekly Progress (5 points)

1. Began writing a description of QCA and its place in social scientific methodology/contemporary usage; this is mostly reading, summarizing, and contextualizing previous research on the methodology as necessary for this present study to justify its use – this will be borrowed pretty heavily when putting pen to paper for the final output.
2. Committed to the use of the QCA R package after much deliberation and read through much of the documentation
3. Practiced with said QCA R package a decent amount on a provided sample dataset and discovered the intricacies of calibration!
4. Subsequently did a lot of research on calibration for fsQCA and found a small amount of debate between sources on whether or not it's okay to use descriptive statistics for your thresholds (e.g., use of mean as crossover point between a 0 and a 1 in csQCA [or something slightly different for fsQCA])
5. Added some surrounding statistics from V-Dem that I neglected to add previously – just some democracy indicators, GDP per capita, education, etc. Will need to decide what's really important when it comes to the actual running through the dataset either this week or next.

Challenges (3 points)

1. While most research on QCA focuses on crisp sets, I will (probably) use fuzzy sets, though my confidence is wavering there in my ability to fully contextualize my study methodologically just due to lack of resources.
2. Another serious concern for my own QCA is determining the cutoff points for membership; this requires a stronger theoretical understanding of my variables, though I will likely just end up using what other similar studies do.
3. Since QCA is a somewhat new methodology, there is still a pretty reasonably sized debate over what best practices are with it, described prior. I will have to take a side on it I suppose, but as long as I can back up my position, I'm not too worried.

Code Commits (2 points)

1. took notes on and tested out QCA
<https://github.com/GW-datasci/26-spring-LUTZ-H/commit/2b5659e47330e87302c099942d7020f07faba595>
2. added some additional surrounding variables
<https://github.com/GW-datasci/26-spring-LUTZ-H/commit/16871bb4cfe0e083e6c77f88173a754f933ba296>